John 16 - 18

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

The last words before the garden.

They will put you out of the synagogues. The time is coming when whoever kills you will think he is serving God.

And then the strangest comfort anyone ever gave. It is to your advantage that I go away.

Because if He does not go, the Counselor does not come.

A little while, and you will not see Me. And again a little while, and you will see Me. They say it back to each other over and over, and nobody understands it.

A woman in labor has sorrow, because her hour has come. And then the child is born and she forgets the pain for joy.

In the world you will have trouble. But take courage. I have overcome the world.

Then He lifts His eyes to heaven and prays out loud, and they get to listen.

This is eternal life: that they know You, the only true God, and Him whom You sent.

Glorify Me with the glory I had with You before the world existed.

Keep them in Your name. Sanctify them in the truth. Your word is truth.

And then He prays for us - for those who will believe through their word - that we may all be one.

Then a brook called Kidron, crossed in the dark, the same brook King David crossed weeping when his own trusted counselor betrayed him.

Soldiers with lanterns and torches, coming to find the light of the world.

Who are you looking for? Jesus of Nazareth. I am.

And they fall backward to the ground.

A sword, an ear, a cup the Father has given Him to drink.

Then a charcoal fire in a courtyard, and a servant girl at the door, and Peter saying the opposite of what Yahshua said in the garden.

He said I am. Peter says I am not.

And the rooster crows.

Then a governor who asks what truth is, standing face to face with the answer, and walks out without waiting to hear it.

I find no basis for a charge against Him.

And the crowd shouts for a robber instead.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 16 - It Is Good That I Go, a Woman in Labor, and I Have Overcome the World

Key Notes

- “These things I have spoken to you, so that you wouldn’t be caused to stumble.” He warns them in advance so that the persecution confirms Him instead of shaking them (John 16:1, 16:4).
- “Whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God.” Saul of Tarsus did exactly that, and later said he thought it his duty (John 16:2, Acts 26:9-10).
- “None of you asks me, ‘Where are you going?’” Peter had asked earlier that night. Now grief has filled them so completely that they have stopped asking (John 16:5-6, 13:36).
- “It is to your advantage that I go away.” Better for them that He leave. While He was in a body He was in one place at a time; the Spirit would be with every one of them, everywhere (John 16:7, 14:16-17).
- The Spirit will convict the world - expose it, prove it wrong - about three things: sin, righteousness, and judgment. Each gets a reason (John 16:8-11).
- Sin, because they do not believe in Me. The root sin named here is not a list of actions but unbelief toward Him (John 16:9).
- Righteousness, because I am going to the Father. The cross looked like the verdict of a guilty man. The return to the Father overturns that verdict (John 16:10).
- Judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged. Past tense, before the cross even happens. The serpent’s head was promised to be crushed from the beginning (John 16:11, Genesis 3:15).
- “I have yet many things to tell you, but you can’t bear them now.” He paces what He tells them. Some truth has to wait until a person can carry it (John 16:12).
- “He will guide you into all truth.” A guide walks with you on a road. The psalmist prayed for the same thing: guide me in your truth, and teach me (John 16:13, Psalm 25:5).
- “He will not speak from himself.” The Spirit points away from Himself to the Son, as the Son points to the Father. Nobody in this Gospel speaks on his own authority (John 16:13-14, 7:16).
- “A little while” is said seven times in four verses. The disciples keep repeating it to each other because they cannot make sense of it. Three days is a little while (John 16:16-19).
- “You will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice.” That is the weekend of the cross exactly - and the next line is your sorrow will be turned into joy, not replaced by it. The same thing that caused the grief becomes the joy (John 16:20).
- The woman in labor is a picture the prophets used for the birth of something new out of pain. Isaiah sets it right before your dead shall live (John 16:21, Isaiah 26:17-19).
- “No one will take your joy away from you.” Joy that comes from a resurrection cannot be undone by anything less (John 16:22).

- “Whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.” In my name is the new thing. They had prayed before; they had never prayed like this (John 16:23-24).
- “The Father himself loves you.” He does not have to persuade a reluctant Father on their behalf. The Father already loves them (John 16:26-27).
- “I came out from the Father, and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.” The whole Gospel in two sentences (John 16:28).
- “Now you speak plainly.” They think they finally understand. Within hours they will scatter (John 16:29-32).
- “You will be scattered, everyone to his own place, and you will leave me alone.” Zechariah said it: strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered (John 16:32, Zechariah 13:7).
- “Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.” Said before the hours on the cross when He will cry out from the psalm about being forsaken - which the other Gospels record and John does not (John 16:32, Mark 15:34).
- “In the world you have oppression.” The word means pressure, crushing, the squeezing of grapes. He does not promise it away (John 16:33).
- “Cheer up! I have overcome the world.” Said by a man about to be arrested, tried, beaten and crucified - in the past tense (John 16:33).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Killing as Service to God	John 16:2 • Acts 26:9-10 • Isaiah 66:5
Ascended on High, Giving Gifts	John 16:7 • Psalm 68:18 • Ephesians 4:8
Judged in Righteousness	John 16:8 • Psalm 9:7-8 • Isaiah 11:4
Guide Me in Your Truth	John 16:13 • Psalm 25:5 • Psalm 143:10
A Little Moment	John 16:16 • Isaiah 26:20 • Hosea 6:1-2
Joy Comes in the Morning	John 16:20 • Psalm 30:5 • Psalm 126:5-6
Zion in Labor	John 16:21 • Isaiah 66:7-9 • Micah 4:10
Be Strong and Courageous	John 16:33 • Joshua 1:9 • Psalm 46:1

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
The Spirit Poured From on High	John 16:7 • Isaiah 32:15 • Joel 2:28
The Serpent Crushed	John 16:11 • Genesis 3:15 • Isaiah 27:1
Declaring Things Before They Happen	John 16:13 • Isaiah 42:9 • Amos 3:7
Labor Pains, Then the Dead Live	John 16:21 • Isaiah 26:17-19
Strike the Shepherd	John 16:32 • Zechariah 13:7

Fulfillment	References
The Lord Yahweh Will Help Me	John 16:32 • Isaiah 50:7-9 • Psalm 23:4

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 16 Commentary (David Guzik) - the work of the Holy Spirit, sorrow turned to joy, and overcoming the world
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 16A - exposition of the promise of the Spirit and the little while

John 16 - Opening Intro

This is the last thing He says to them before the garden. And He is getting them ready.

I am telling you this so you will not stumble. They are going to throw you out of the synagogues. In fact the time is coming when somebody will kill you and think he is doing God a favor.

And that is exactly what happened. A young Pharisee named Saul thought he was serving God while he dragged believers off to prison. Later he said, I really thought I was supposed to do that.

And Yahshua notices something. Earlier that night Peter had asked where are You going. Now nobody asks anymore. Sorrow has filled their hearts so full there is no room left for questions.

And so He tells them the strangest comfort anybody ever gave. It is better for you that I go away.

Better? How can it be better?

Because if I do not go, the Counselor will not come to you. But if I go, I will send Him to you.

While He walked in a body, He could only be in one room at a time. Sitting by one well. Standing in one boat. The Spirit would be with every one of them, in every place, all at once.

And when the Spirit comes, He will convict the world. Of sin - because they do not believe in Me. Of righteousness - because I am going to the Father. Of judgment - because the ruler of this world has been judged.

Notice that last one is in the past tense. Before the cross even happens. As far as heaven is concerned, the serpent's head is already crushed.

Then He says something tender. I have many more things to tell you, but you cannot bear them now. He does not dump it all on them. He gives them what they can carry.

And then: a little while and you will not see Me. And again a little while and you will see Me.

And they are whispering to each other. What is this little while? We do not know what He is talking about. They say little while so many times it becomes almost funny. Seven times in four verses.

Three days. That is the little while.

And He says: you will weep and mourn, and the world will celebrate. You will be sorrowful - but your sorrow will be turned into joy.

Turned into. Not replaced by. The very thing that broke their hearts - the cross - becomes the source of their joy.

And then He gives them the picture. A woman in labor has pain, because her hour has come. But when the baby comes, she does not even remember the anguish, for joy that a child is born.

And Isaiah uses that exact picture. Like a woman with child crying out in her pains - and the very next line is: your dead shall live. My dead bodies shall arise. The labor ends in resurrection.

And no one will take your joy from you.

And He says: until now you have not asked anything in My name. Ask, and you will receive, so your joy will be full. And then: I am not saying I will ask the Father for you - the Father Himself loves you.

Some of you picture a Father who has to be talked into loving you. He already does.

And they say: now You are talking plainly! Now we believe! And He says: do you? The hour is coming - it is already here - when you will be scattered, every one to his own home, and you will leave Me alone.

Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will scatter. Zechariah said it.

And then: yet I am not alone, because the Father is with Me.

And His last words before the prayer: I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have trouble. But take courage. I have overcome the world.

He said that in the past tense. On the night He was arrested.

Before we read - He never promised them a world without trouble. He promised them peace in Him, in the middle of it. That is still the promise.

John 16:1-33 (WEB)

1 “I have said these things to you so that you wouldn’t be caused to stumble.

2 They will put you out of the synagogues. Yes, the time comes that whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God.[1]

3 They will do these things because they have not known the Father, nor me.

4 But I have told you these things, so that when the time comes, you may remember that I told you about them. I didn't tell you these things from the beginning, because I was with you.

5 But now I am going to him who sent me, and none of you asks me, 'Where are you going?'

6 But because I have told you these things, sorrow has filled your heart.

7 Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away, for if I don't go away, the Counselor won't come to you. But if I go, I will send him to you.[2,3]

8 When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment;[4]

9 about sin, because they don't believe in me;

10 about righteousness, because I am going to my Father, and you won't see me any more;

11 about judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged.[5]

12 "I have yet many things to tell you, but you can't bear them now.

13 However when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming.[6,7]

14 He will glorify me, for he will take from what is mine, and will declare it to you.

15 All things whatever the Father has are mine; therefore I said that he takes of mine, and will declare it to you.

16 A little while, and you will not see me. Again a little while, and you will see me."[8]

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Acts 26:9-10 • Isaiah 66:5 - *Saul thinking he ought to oppose the name and voting for the death of the saints, and brothers who cast you out for my name's sake*

[2] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 68:18 • Ephesians 4:8 - *you have ascended on high and received gifts among men, and when he ascended he gave gifts to men*

[3] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 32:15 • Joel 2:28 - *until the Spirit is poured on us from on high, and I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 9:7-8 • Isaiah 11:4 - *he will judge the world in righteousness, and with righteousness he will judge the poor*

[5] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Genesis 3:15 • Isaiah 27:1 - *the seed of the woman bruising the serpent's head, and Yahweh punishing leviathan the twisted serpent*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 25:5 • Psalm 143:10 - *guide me in your truth and teach me, and your Spirit is good, lead me*

[7] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:9 • Amos 3:7 - *I declare new things and tell you about them before they come up, and the Lord Yahweh reveals his secret to the prophets*

[8] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 26:20 • Hosea 6:1-2 - *hide yourself for a little moment until the indignation is past, and on the third day he will raise us up*

17 Some of his disciples therefore said to one another, “What is this that he says to us, ‘A little while, and you won’t see me, and again a little while, and you will see me;’ and, ‘Because I go to the Father’?”

18 They said therefore, “What is this that he says, ‘A little while’? We don’t know what he is saying.”

19 Therefore Jesus perceived that they wanted to ask him, and he said to them, “Do you inquire among yourselves concerning this, that I said, ‘A little while, and you won’t see me, and again a little while, and you will see me?’

20 Most certainly I tell you, that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. You will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy.[9]

21 A woman, when she gives birth, has sorrow, because her time has come. But when she has delivered the child, she doesn’t remember the anguish any more, for the joy that a human being is born into the world.[10,11]

22 Therefore you now have sorrow, but I will see you again, and your heart will rejoice, and no one will take your joy away from you.

23 “In that day you will ask me no questions. Most certainly I tell you, whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.

24 Until now, you have asked nothing in my name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be made full.

25 I have spoken these things to you in figures of speech. But the time is coming when I will no more speak to you in figures of speech, but will tell you plainly about the Father.

26 In that day you will ask in my name; and I don’t say to you, that I will pray to the Father for you,

27 for the Father himself loves you, because you have loved me, and have believed that I came from God.

28 I came from the Father, and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.”

29 His disciples said to him, “Behold, now you are speaking plainly, and using no figures of speech.

30 Now we know that you know all things, and don’t need for anyone to question you. By this we believe that you came from God.”

31 Jesus answered them, “Do you now believe?

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[9] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 30:5 • Psalm 126:5-6 - *weeping may stay for the night but joy comes in the morning, and those who sow in tears will reap in joy*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 26:17-19 - *as a woman with child cries out in her pangs, and then: your dead shall live, my dead bodies shall arise*

[11] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 66:7-9 • Micah 4:10 - *as soon as Zion travailed she gave birth, and labor to give birth, daughter of Zion, for there Yahweh will redeem you*

32 Behold, the time is coming, yes, and has now come, that you will be scattered, everyone to his own place, and you will leave me alone. Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.[12,13]

33 I have told you these things, that in me you may have peace. In the world you have oppression; but cheer up! I have overcome the world."[14]

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[12] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 13:7 - *strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered*

[13] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 50:7-9 • Psalm 23:4 - *the Lord Yahweh will help me and he who justifies me is near, and I will fear no evil, for you are with me*

[14] **Cross-Reference:** Joshua 1:9 • Psalm 46:1 - *be strong and courageous, Yahweh your God is with you wherever you go, and God is our refuge and strength*

CHAPTER 17 - The Prayer Before the Garden, the Glory Before the World, and That They May Be One

Key Notes

- He lifted up His eyes to heaven. The disciples are not told to close theirs. They are meant to hear every word of this prayer, and so are we (John 17:1, Psalm 123:1).
- This chapter is often called the high priestly prayer. The high priest carried the names of the tribes of Israel on his shoulders and over his heart when he went in before Yahweh. Here the names are carried in prayer (John 17:9, Exodus 28:12, 28:29).
- “Father, the time has come.” The hour that was not yet at Cana, and arrived when the Greeks came, is now (John 17:1, 2:4, 12:23).
- “This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent.” Eternal life is defined here not as duration but as knowing. Jeremiah said: let him who glories glory in this, that he understands and knows me (John 17:3, Jeremiah 9:24).
- Knowing, in Hebrew thought, is not information. It is the word used for the closest of all relationships. Hosea says Yahweh desires the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings (John 17:3, Hosea 6:6).
- “I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do.” Said before the cross, as though it were already done. Tomorrow He will say it is finished (John 17:4, 19:30).
- “Glorify me with the glory which I had with you before the world existed.” Yahweh said in Isaiah: my glory I will not give to another. Either the Son is claiming what no creature can have, or He is not another (John 17:5, Isaiah 42:8).
- “I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me.” The psalm says I will declare your name to my brothers, and Hebrews puts those words in His mouth. Making the Name known was His work (John 17:6, Psalm 22:22).
- “They were yours, and you have given them to me.” The disciples were the Father’s before they were the Son’s, a gift passed from one to the other (John 17:6).
- “I pray not for the world, but for those whom you have given me.” Not that He does not care for the world - He came for it - but this prayer is for His own (John 17:9, 3:16).
- “Keep them through your name which you have given me.” The Father’s name was given to the Son. Yahweh said of the angel who went before Israel: my name is in him (John 17:11, Exodus 23:21).
- “That they may be one, even as we are.” The unity He asks for is modeled on the unity of the Father and the Son. Not uniformity - oneness (John 17:11, 10:30).
- “None of them is lost, except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.” Peter later quotes the psalms about Judas: let another take his office (John 17:12, Psalm 109:8, Acts 1:20).

- “That they may have my joy made full in themselves.” Joy again, on the night before the cross (John 17:13, 15:11).
- “I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one.” Not removal, but protection in the middle of it (John 17:15, Psalm 121:7).
- “Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth.” The psalm says your law is truth, and all your words are truth. To be sanctified is to be set apart, and the word does the setting apart (John 17:17, Psalm 119:142, 119:160).
- “For their sakes I sanctify myself.” Priests were consecrated before they could serve. He sets Himself apart for the offering He is about to make (John 17:19, Exodus 29:1).
- “Not for these only, but for those also who will believe in me through their word.” That is everyone who has believed since. You were prayed for, on purpose, the night before the cross (John 17:20).
- “That they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you.” The unity of believers is meant to be the evidence that the Father sent the Son. The world is supposed to see it (John 17:21, 17:23).
- Ezekiel’s two sticks, Judah and Joseph, were joined into one stick in Yahweh’s hand. The prayer for oneness lands on a very old promise (John 17:21, Ezekiel 37:17).
- “You loved them, even as you loved me.” The Father loves those who belong to the Son with the same love He has for the Son (John 17:23).
- “I desire that they also may be with me where I am, that they may see my glory.” The psalmist said: I will be satisfied, when I awake, with seeing your form (John 17:24, Psalm 17:15).
- “Before the foundation of the world” - the love between the Father and the Son was before there was a world to love (John 17:24).
- “I made known to them your name, and will make it known.” The prayer ends where it began: the Name, and the love, and Him in them (John 17:26).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
I Lift Up My Eyes	John 17:1 • Psalm 123:1 • Psalm 121:1-2
Knowing Yahweh	John 17:3 • Jeremiah 9:24 • Hosea 6:6
Names Carried Before Yahweh	John 17:9 • Exodus 28:12 • Exodus 28:29
Kept From All Evil	John 17:15 • Psalm 121:7 • Psalm 91:11
Your Word Is Truth	John 17:17 • Psalm 119:142 • Psalm 119:160
Consecrated to Minister	John 17:19 • Exodus 29:1 • Leviticus 8:12
Brothers Living in Unity	John 17:21 • Psalm 133:1 • Ezekiel 37:17
Satisfied With Seeing Your Form	John 17:24 • Psalm 17:15 • Psalm 16:11

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
My Glory I Will Not Give to Another	John 17:5 • Isaiah 42:8 • Proverbs 8:22-23
I Will Declare Your Name	John 17:6 • Psalm 22:22 • Exodus 3:15
My Name Is in Him	John 17:11 • Exodus 23:21 • Isaiah 52:6
Let Another Take His Office	John 17:12 • Psalm 109:8 • Psalm 41:9
A Priest Forever Who Intercedes	John 17:20 • Psalm 110:4 • Isaiah 53:12
My Holy Name Made Known	John 17:26 • Ezekiel 39:7 • Psalm 102:15

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 17 Commentary (David Guzik) - the high priestly prayer, eternal life, sanctification, and unity
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 17A - exposition of the prayer of Yahshua for His disciples

John 17 - Opening Intro

This whole chapter is a prayer. And the most amazing thing about it is that He prays it out loud, with His eyes open, lifted up to heaven, so the disciples can hear every word.

We get to listen to the Son talk to the Father on the night before the cross.

People call it the high priestly prayer. And think about what the high priest did. He wore two stones on his shoulders with the names of the tribes of Israel carved in them, and a breastplate over his heart with their names again. Every time he went in before Yahweh, he carried them in with him.

That is this chapter. He is carrying them in.

Father, the hour has come. Glorify Your Son, so that Your Son may glorify You.

And then He defines eternal life. Not how long you live. This is eternal life - that they know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ whom You sent.

Eternal life is knowing Him. And knowing in Scripture is not just knowing about. It is the word for the closest relationship there is. Jeremiah - let him who boasts boast in this, that he knows Me. Hosea - I want the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings.

And then: I glorified You on earth. I finished the work You gave Me to do. He says it like it is already done. Tomorrow on the cross He will say it is finished.

And then the line that should stop everybody. Father, glorify Me with the glory I had with You before the world existed.

Now go to Isaiah 42. I am Yahweh. That is My name. My glory I will not give to another.

So either the Son is asking for something God said He would never give to anybody else - or the Son is not anybody else.

Then He prays for the disciples. I revealed Your name to the men You gave Me. They were Yours, and You gave them to Me, and they kept Your word.

Kept Your word. These are the same men who are about to run. And He describes them as faithful. That is how He sees His own.

Holy Father, keep them through Your name, the name You gave Me, so they may be one as We are one.

The name You gave Me. Remember the angel in Exodus that went before Israel? God said: listen to his voice, because My name is in him.

And He says: I kept them. Not one of them was lost except the son of destruction, so the Scripture would be fulfilled.

And then: I do not pray that You take them out of the world. I pray that You keep them from the evil one.

Some of us keep praying to be taken out. He prays for us to be kept in it.

Sanctify them in Your truth. Your word is truth.

And then - this is the part I want you to hear tonight - He says: I am not praying for these alone, but also for those who will believe in Me through their word.

That is you. If you believe because of what those men preached and wrote down, you were in that prayer. You were prayed for, on purpose, on the night before the cross, two thousand years ago.

And what did He pray for you? That they may all be one. As You, Father, are in Me and I in You - that they also may be one in Us, so the world may believe that You sent Me.

Our unity is supposed to be the evidence. The world is supposed to look at how we treat each other and conclude that the Father sent the Son.

And then: Father, I want those You have given Me to be with Me where I am, so they can see My glory - the glory You gave Me because You loved Me before the foundation of the world.

Before there was a world, there was love. The Father and the Son, loving each other. And He wants you there to see it.

Before we read - you have been prayed for. By Him. Read this chapter like somebody listening to the Son talk to the Father about him.

John 17:1-26 (WEB)

1 Jesus said these things, and lifting up his eyes to heaven, he said, “Father, the time has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may also glorify you;[15]

2 even as you gave him authority over all flesh, so he will give eternal life to all whom you have given him.

3 This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent, Jesus Christ.[16]

4 I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do.

5 Now, Father, glorify me with your own self with the glory which I had with you before the world existed.[17]

6 I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me out of the world. They were yours, and you have given them to me. They have kept your word.[18]

7 Now they have known that all things whatever you have given me are from you,

8 for the words which you have given me I have given to them, and they received them, and knew for sure that I came from you, and they have believed that you sent me.

9 I pray for them. I don’t pray for the world, but for those whom you have given me, for they are yours.[19]

10 All things that are mine are yours, and yours are mine, and I am glorified in them.

11 I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, keep them through your name which you have given me, that they may be one, even as we are.[20]

12 While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. Those whom you have given me I have kept. None of them is lost, except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.[21]

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[15] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 123:1 • Psalm 121:1-2 - *to you I lift up my eyes, you who sit in the heavens, and my help comes from Yahweh*

[16] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 9:24 • Hosea 6:6 - *let him who glories glory in this, that he knows me, and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings*

[17] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 42:8 • Proverbs 8:22-23 - *I am Yahweh, that is my name, I will not give my glory to another, and wisdom set up from everlasting before the earth existed*

[18] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:22 • Exodus 3:15 - *I will declare your name to my brothers, and this is my name forever, my memorial to all generations*

[19] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 28:12 • Exodus 28:29 - *Aaron bearing the names of Israel on his shoulders and on his heart before Yahweh*

[20] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 23:21 • Isaiah 52:6 - *listen to his voice, for my name is in him, and my people shall know my name*

13 But now I come to you, and I say these things in the world, that they may have my joy made full in themselves.

14 I have given them your word. The world hated them, because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.

15 I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one.[22]

16 They are not of the world even as I am not of the world.

17 Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth.[23]

18 As you sent me into the world, even so I have sent them into the world.

19 For their sakes I sanctify myself, that they themselves also may be sanctified in truth.[24]

20 Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who will believe in me through their word,[25]

21 that they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.[26]

22 The glory which you have given me, I have given to them; that they may be one, even as we are one;

23 I in them, and you in me, that they may be perfected into one; that the world may know that you sent me, and loved them, even as you loved me.

24 Father, I desire that they also whom you have given me be with me where I am, that they may see my glory, which you have given me, for you loved me before the foundation of the world.[27]

25 Righteous Father, the world hasn't known you, but I knew you; and these knew that you sent me.

26 I made known to them your name, and will make it known; that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them."[28]

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[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 109:8 • Psalm 41:9 - *let his days be few and another take his office, and my familiar friend has lifted up his heel against me*

[22] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 121:7 • Psalm 91:11 - *Yahweh will keep you from all evil, and his angels in charge of you to guard you*

[23] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 119:142 • Psalm 119:160 - *your law is truth, and all of your words are truth*

[24] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 29:1 • Leviticus 8:12 - *what you shall do to make them holy to minister as priests, and the anointing oil poured on Aaron's head to sanctify him*

[25] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 110:4 • Isaiah 53:12 - *a priest forever in the order of Melchizedek, and he made intercession for the transgressors*

[26] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 133:1 • Ezekiel 37:17 - *how good and pleasant for brothers to live together in unity, and the two sticks joined into one in your hand*

[27] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 17:15 • Psalm 16:11 - *I shall be satisfied when I awake with seeing your form, and in your presence is fullness of joy*

[28] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 39:7 • Psalm 102:15 - *I will make my holy name known among my people Israel, and the nations will fear Yahweh's name*

CHAPTER 18 - Across the Kidron, I Am and They Fell Back, and What Is Truth?

Key Notes

- He crossed the brook Kidron, the valley between Jerusalem and the Mount of Olives. King David crossed the same brook weeping, fleeing the city after his trusted counselor Ahithophel joined the rebellion against him. Ahithophel later went home and hanged himself (John 18:1, 2 Samuel 15:23, 15:31, 17:23).
- Only John calls it a garden. The first Adam fell in a garden. The last Adam was arrested in one, and will be buried in one (John 18:1, 19:41).
- Judas knew the place because Yahshua often met there with His disciples. Betrayal uses what friendship knows (John 18:2).
- The detachment was a Roman cohort, or part of one, with officers from the chief priests. Rome and the temple came for Him together (John 18:3, 18:12).
- They came with lanterns and torches to find the light of the world (John 18:3, 8:12).
- “Jesus therefore, knowing all the things that were happening to him, went out.” He was not found. He stepped forward (John 18:4).
- “I am he” is ego eimi once more, and this time a company of soldiers goes backward and falls to the ground at the words. The psalmist said: when evildoers came at me, they stumbled and fell (John 18:5-6, Psalm 27:2).
- John notes that Judas was standing with them. He was on the wrong side of the line when the words were spoken (John 18:5).
- “If therefore you seek me, let these go.” John says this fulfilled His own word: of those you gave me, I have lost none. The shepherd stands between the wolf and the sheep (John 18:8-9, 17:12).
- Only John names Peter as the one with the sword and Malchus as the servant who lost his ear. By the time John wrote, perhaps it no longer endangered anyone to say so (John 18:10).
- “The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not surely drink it?” The prophets speak of the cup of Yahweh’s wrath. He drinks it willingly (John 18:11, Isaiah 51:17, Psalm 75:8).
- He was taken first to Annas, father-in-law of Caiaphas. Annas had been high priest years before and had been removed by the Romans, but five of his sons and his son-in-law held the office after him. He was still the power behind it (John 18:13, Luke 3:2).
- Another disciple, known to the high priest, got Peter into the courtyard. Most take him to be the beloved disciple, John himself (John 18:15-16).
- “Are you also one of this man’s disciples?” “I am not.” In the garden Yahshua said I am, and an armed company fell down. In the courtyard Peter says I am not to a servant girl (John 18:17).

- The fire was a fire of coals - a charcoal fire. The word appears in only one other place in the New Testament: the charcoal fire on the beach where Yahshua restores Peter. Denied by one, restored by the other (John 18:18, 21:9).
- “I spoke openly to the world… in secret I said nothing.” Yahweh says the same in Isaiah: I have not spoken in secret, in a place of the land of darkness (John 18:20, Isaiah 45:19).
- An officer struck Him with his hand. Micah said: they will strike the judge of Israel with a rod on the cheek. Isaiah’s servant said: I gave my cheeks to those who plucked out the hair (John 18:22, Micah 5:1, Isaiah 50:6).
- “If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil.” He does not turn the other cheek by staying silent. He asks for a lawful charge. Meekness is not the same as having no voice (John 18:23).
- The third denial comes from a relative of Malchus, the man whose ear Peter cut off. Didn’t I see you in the garden with him? Then the rooster crowed (John 18:26-27).
- “They themselves didn’t enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover.” On the morning of the trial the Passover had not yet been eaten. John has been consistent about this since chapter 13 (John 18:28, 13:1, 19:14).
- Careful not to be defiled by a Gentile’s house, they were in the middle of handing an innocent man over to be killed. The irony needs no comment (John 18:28).
- “It is illegal for us to put anyone to death.” Rome kept the power of execution. That is why He would die by crucifixion rather than stoning - lifted up, as He had said, the kind of death He would die (John 18:31-32, 12:32-33).
- Psalm 22 describes the sufferer’s hands and feet pierced - the reading of the Septuagint and of the WEB, which the Masoretic text has as like a lion. Zechariah says they will look on me whom they have pierced (John 18:32, Psalm 22:16, Zechariah 12:10).
- “Are you the King of the Jews?” is Pilate’s first question in all four Gospels. It was the charge Rome cared about (John 18:33).
- “My Kingdom is not of this world.” Not from this world - its source is elsewhere. It is not that the kingdom has nothing to do with the earth; Daniel saw it filling the earth. It does not come by the means this world uses (John 18:36, Daniel 2:44).
- “If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight.” One of them had already drawn a sword, and been told to put it away (John 18:36, 18:11).
- “For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth.” Born, and came into the world - two statements, one about birth and one about coming from somewhere else (John 18:37).
- “What is truth?” Pilate asked it standing in front of the one who had said I am the truth, and walked out without waiting for an answer (John 18:38, 14:6).
- “I find no basis for a charge against him.” The first of three times Pilate says it. The Passover lamb had to be without defect, and the Roman judge examines Him and finds none (John 18:38, 19:4, 19:6, Exodus 12:5).

- Barabbas was a robber - the word was used for bandits and violent rebels. His name means son of the father. On the Day of Atonement one goat died and the other was sent away alive. Many have seen the picture here; John simply tells what happened (John 18:40, Leviticus 16:8-10).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
David Crossing the Kidron	John 18:1 • 2 Samuel 15:23 • 2 Samuel 15:31
Lanterns in the Dark	John 18:3 • Job 24:13 • Psalm 139:12
Annas and Caiaphas	John 18:13 • Luke 3:2 • Acts 4:6
Not Spoken in Secret	John 18:20 • Isaiah 45:19 • Isaiah 48:16
Do Not Curse a Ruler	John 18:23 • Exodus 22:28 • Acts 23:5
Defiled and Unable to Keep the Passover	John 18:28 • Numbers 9:6 • Numbers 9:10
Hanged on a Tree	John 18:32 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23 • Galatians 3:13
Two Goats	John 18:40 • Leviticus 16:8-10

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
They Stumbled and Fell	John 18:6 • Psalm 27:2 • Psalm 35:4
None of Them Lost	John 18:9 • Ezekiel 34:16 • Isaiah 40:11
The Cup in Yahweh's Hand	John 18:11 • Isaiah 51:17 • Psalm 75:8
Struck on the Cheek	John 18:22 • Micah 5:1 • Isaiah 50:6
Pierced	John 18:32 • Psalm 22:16 • Zechariah 12:10
A Kingdom That Will Never Be Destroyed	John 18:36 • Daniel 2:44 • Daniel 7:27
A Lamb Without Defect	John 18:38 • Exodus 12:5 • Isaiah 53:9

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 18 Commentary (David Guzik) - the arrest in the garden, Peter's denials, and Yahshua before Annas and Pilate
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 18A - exposition of the betrayal, arrest and trials

John 18 - Opening Intro

When He finished praying, He went out with His disciples across the brook Kidron.

Now that is not just a geography note. A thousand years earlier King David crossed that same brook. He was leaving Jerusalem on foot, weeping, because his own son had rebelled against him - and his most trusted counselor, Ahithophel, had joined the conspiracy. And Ahithophel, when it all fell apart, went home and hanged himself.

A king crossing the Kidron, betrayed by a friend who would hang himself. John does not have to say a word. Anybody who knows the story sees it.

And they go into a garden. John is the only one who calls it a garden. The first Adam fell in a garden. The last Adam is arrested in one. And in the next chapter, He will be buried in one.

And Judas knows the place, because Yahshua went there often with His disciples. Betrayal always uses what friendship knows.

And here they come. A detachment of Roman soldiers and the temple police, with lanterns and torches and weapons.

Lanterns and torches. Coming to find the Light of the world.

And John says: Jesus, knowing everything that was going to happen to Him, went out and said, who are you looking for?

He did not hide. He was not caught. He walked out to meet them.

Jesus of Nazareth. And He says: I am.

Ego eimi. The same words He said to the woman at the well, and on the water, and before Abraham was.

And the whole armed company goes backward and falls on the ground.

Think about that. Soldiers. Weapons. And two words knock them flat. And then He lets them get up and arrest Him.

Nobody took His life from Him. He laid it down.

He asks again: who are you looking for? Jesus of Nazareth. I told you I am. So if you are looking for Me, let these men go.

The shepherd steps between the wolves and the sheep.

And then Peter pulls out a sword and swings, and cuts off the right ear of the high priest's servant. John is the only one who tells us their names. Peter, and Malchus.

And Yahshua says: put your sword away. The cup the Father has given Me - shall I not drink it?

The cup of wrath the prophets talked about. He is not running from it. He is reaching for it.

They tie Him up and take Him first to Annas. Annas had been high priest before, and the Romans removed him - but his sons and his son-in-law Caiaphas held the job after him. He was still running things.

And Peter follows. Another disciple who knows the high priest gets him into the courtyard. And at the door the servant girl looks at Peter and says: you are not one of His disciples too, are you?

And Peter says: I am not.

Hear it. An hour ago in the garden, Yahshua said I am, and soldiers fell to the ground. Now Peter says I am not, to a servant girl at a door.

And it is cold, and they have made a charcoal fire, and Peter stands there warming himself with the people who arrested his Lord.

And remember that charcoal fire. Because the only other time that word shows up in the whole New Testament is on a beach in chapter 21, where Yahshua cooks breakfast for Peter and restores him. Denied at one charcoal fire. Restored at another.

Inside, Annas questions Yahshua. And He says: I spoke openly. I taught in the synagogues and the temple. I said nothing in secret. Ask the people who heard Me.

And an officer slaps Him across the face. Micah said they would strike the judge of Israel on the cheek.

And Yahshua says: if I said something wrong, testify about what was wrong. But if I spoke rightly, why do you hit Me?

Meek does not mean silent. He asked for justice.

Then back outside. Two more questions. Two more denials. And the last one comes from a relative of Malchus - the man whose ear Peter cut off. Did I not see you in the garden with Him?

And the rooster crows.

Then early in the morning they take Him to the Roman governor. And John tells us something important. They would not go into the governor’s house, because they did not want to be defiled - they still needed to eat the Passover.

The Passover had not been eaten yet. John has been telling us that since chapter 13. The supper was before the Passover. And at that very moment the Lamb of God was being handed over.

And think about the irony. They will not walk into a Gentile’s house in case it makes them unclean - while they are handing over an innocent man to be killed.

Pilate asks: are You the King of the Jews? And Yahshua says: My kingdom is not of this world. If it were, My servants would fight.

Not of this world means it does not come from here. It does not run on swords. Daniel saw it as a stone cut without hands that fills the whole earth. It just does not come the way this world's kingdoms come.

And He says: I was born for this. I came into the world to testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth hears My voice.

And Pilate says: what is truth?

And walks out. Standing face to face with the One who said I am the truth, he asked the biggest question in the world - and did not wait for the answer.

And he goes out and tells the crowd: I find no basis for a charge against Him.

The Passover lamb had to be examined and found without defect. The Roman judge examined Him and found nothing.

And then Pilate offers them a choice - and they shout for Barabbas. A robber. A violent man. And his name means son of the father.

Before we read - notice who stands and who falls in this chapter. The soldiers fall at I am. Peter falls at a servant girl's question. Pilate falls at what is truth. And the only one standing the whole time is the one they tied up.

John 18:1-40 (WEB)

1 When Jesus had spoken these words, he went out with his disciples over the brook Kidron, where there was a garden, into which he and his disciples entered.[29]

2 Now Judas, who betrayed him, also knew the place, for Jesus often met there with his disciples.

3 Judas then, having taken a detachment of soldiers and officers from the chief priests and the Pharisees, came there with lanterns, torches, and weapons.[30]

4 Jesus therefore, knowing all the things that were happening to him, went out, and said to them, "Who are you looking for?"

5 They answered him, "Jesus of Nazareth." Jesus said to them, "I am he." Judas also, who betrayed him, was standing with them.

6 When therefore he said to them, "I am he," they went backward, and fell to the ground.[31]

7 Again therefore he asked them, "Who are you looking for?" They said, "Jesus of Nazareth."

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[29] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Samuel 15:23 • 2 Samuel 15:31 - *the king passing over the brook Kidron while the country wept, and Ahithophel among the conspirators*

[30] **Cross-Reference:** Job 24:13 • Psalm 139:12 - *those who rebel against the light, and the darkness that does not hide from you*

[31] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 27:2 • Psalm 35:4 - *when evildoers came at me they stumbled and fell, and let those who plot my ruin be turned back*

8 Jesus answered, “I told you that I am he. If therefore you seek me, let these go their way,”

9 that the word might be fulfilled which he spoke, “Of those whom you have given me, I have lost none.”[32]

10 Simon Peter therefore, having a sword, drew it, and struck the high priest’s servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant’s name was Malchus.

11 Jesus therefore said to Peter, “Put the sword into its sheath. The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not surely drink it?”[33]

12 So the detachment, the commanding officer, and the officers of the Jews, seized Jesus and bound him,

13 and led him to Annas first, for he was father-in-law to Caiaphas, who was high priest that year.[34]

14 Now it was Caiaphas who advised the Jews that it was expedient that one man should perish for the people.

15 Simon Peter followed Jesus, as did another disciple. Now that disciple was known to the high priest, and entered in with Jesus into the court of the high priest;

16 but Peter was standing at the door outside. So the other disciple, who was known to the high priest, went out and spoke to her who kept the door, and brought in Peter.

17 Then the maid who kept the door said to Peter, “Are you also one of this man’s disciples?” He said, “I am not.”

18 Now the servants and the officers were standing there, having made a fire of coals, for it was cold. They were warming themselves. Peter was with them, standing and warming himself.

19 The high priest therefore asked Jesus about his disciples, and about his teaching.

20 Jesus answered him, “I spoke openly to the world. I always taught in synagogues, and in the temple, where the Jews always meet. I said nothing in secret.[35]

21 Why do you ask me? Ask those who have heard me what I said to them. Behold, these know the things which I said.”

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[32] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 34:16 • Isaiah 40:11 - *I will seek that which was lost and bind up the broken, and he will gather the lambs in his arm*

[33] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 51:17 • Psalm 75:8 - *the cup of his wrath drunk from Yahweh’s hand, and the cup in Yahweh’s hand poured out*

[34] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 3:2 • Acts 4:6 - *the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, and Annas the high priest with Caiaphas and the high priest’s relatives*

[35] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 45:19 • Isaiah 48:16 - *I have not spoken in secret, in a place of the land of darkness, and from the beginning I have not spoken in secret*

22 When he had said this, one of the officers standing by slapped Jesus with his hand, saying, “Do you answer the high priest like that?”[36]

23 Jesus answered him, “If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil; but if well, why do you beat me?”[37]

24 Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas, the high priest.

25 Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They said therefore to him, “You aren’t also one of his disciples, are you?” He denied it, and said, “I am not.”

26 One of the servants of the high priest, being a relative of him whose ear Peter had cut off, said, “Didn’t I see you in the garden with him?”

27 Peter therefore denied it again, and immediately the rooster crowed.

28 They led Jesus therefore from Caiaphas into the Praetorium. It was early, and they themselves didn’t enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover.[38]

29 Pilate therefore went out to them, and said, “What accusation do you bring against this man?”

30 They answered him, “If this man weren’t an evildoer, we wouldn’t have delivered him up to you.”

31 Pilate therefore said to them, “Take him yourselves, and judge him according to your law.” Therefore the Jews said to him, “It is not lawful for us to put anyone to death,”

32 that the word of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spoke, signifying by what kind of death he should die.[39,40]

33 Pilate therefore entered again into the Praetorium, called Jesus, and said to him, “Are you the King of the Jews?”

34 Jesus answered him, “Do you say this by yourself, or did others tell you about me?”

35 Pilate answered, “I’m not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests delivered you to me. What have you done?”

36 Jesus answered, “My Kingdom is not of this world. If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight, that I wouldn’t be delivered to the Jews. But now my Kingdom is not from here.”[41]

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[36] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Micah 5:1 • Isaiah 50:6 - *they will strike the judge of Israel with a rod on the cheek, and I gave my cheeks to those who plucked off the hair*

[37] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 22:28 • Acts 23:5 - *you shall not curse a ruler of your people*

[38] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 9:6 • Numbers 9:10 - *men unclean who could not keep the Passover on that day, and the provision for the unclean to keep it still*

[39] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 21:22-23 • Galatians 3:13 - *he who is hanged on a tree is accursed of God, and Messiah becoming a curse for us*

[40] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:16 • Zechariah 12:10 - *they have pierced my hands and feet, and they will look to me whom they have pierced*

[41] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 2:44 • Daniel 7:27 - *the God of heaven setting up a kingdom that will never be destroyed, and an everlasting kingdom that all dominions will serve*

37 Pilate therefore said to him, “Are you a king then?” Jesus answered, “You say that I am a king. For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice.”

38 Pilate said to him, “What is truth?” When he had said this, he went out again to the Jews, and said to them, “I find no basis for a charge against him.[42]

39 But you have a custom, that I should release someone to you at the Passover. Therefore, do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?”

40 Then they all shouted again, saying, “Not this man, but Barabbas!” Now Barabbas was a robber.[43]

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[42] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 12:5 • Isaiah 53:9 - *your lamb shall be without defect, and he had done no violence, nor was any deceit in his mouth*

[43] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 16:8-10 - *lots cast for two goats, one offered for a sin offering and the other sent away alive*

Major Themes Across John 16-18

- Persecution foretold so that it would confirm faith instead of breaking it
- Men who kill and believe they are serving God
- Grief so full it stopped asking questions
- The advantage of His going: the Spirit with every one of them everywhere
- Sin, righteousness, and judgment, with the prince already judged
- Truth given at the pace a person can carry it
- A little while, said seven times, meaning three days
- Sorrow turned into joy, not replaced by it
- Labor pains that end in your dead shall live
- A Father who does not need persuading to love
- Scattered sheep, and a Shepherd who was not alone
- Peace in Him and pressure in the world, and the world already overcome
- A prayer spoken aloud so that we could hear it
- Names carried before the Father like the stones on the high priest's shoulders
- Eternal life defined as knowing Him
- The glory Yahweh gives to no other, asked for by the Son
- The Father's name given to the Son
- Kept in the world, not taken out of it
- Sanctified by the word, which is truth
- Prayed for before we were born: those who would believe through their word
- Oneness as the evidence that the Father sent the Son
- Love before the foundation of the world
- A king crossing the Kidron, betrayed by a friend
- A garden where the last Adam was arrested
- Lanterns and torches searching for the light of the world
- I am, and an armed company on the ground
- A shepherd stepping between the soldiers and the sheep
- The cup received, not refused
- I am, and I am not: the Master and the disciple on the same night
- Two charcoal fires, one for denial and one for restoration
- Struck on the cheek, and asking for justice rather than staying silent
- Careful not to be defiled while delivering the innocent to death

- A kingdom not from this world, which does not run on swords
- What is truth, asked of the truth, without waiting for an answer
- No fault found in the Lamb

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we not stumble when the hard things He warned us about arrive.

May we never mistake cruelty for service to God.

May we welcome the Counselor He sent.

May the Spirit guide us into all truth.

May we carry what He gives us at the pace He gives it.

May our sorrow be turned into joy.

May no one take our joy from us.

May we ask the Father in His name, knowing the Father loves us.

May we take courage, because He has overcome the world.

May we know the only true God, and the One He sent.

May we keep His word, as He says His disciples did.

May we be kept from the evil one while we remain in the world.

May we be sanctified in His truth.

May we remember that He prayed for us before we were born.

May we be one, so that the world may believe.

May we be with Him where He is, and see His glory.

May we step forward when He calls, as He stepped forward in the garden.

May every enemy fall back at the name I AM.

May we put away the sword and drink the cup we are given.

May we never say I am not about the One who said I am.

May the charcoal fire of our failure lead us to the fire of His restoration.

May we speak openly and say nothing in secret we would be ashamed of.

May we ask for justice without losing our meekness.

May we serve the kingdom that is not from this world.

May we wait for the answer when we ask what truth is.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.